

received email containing links to legitimate appearing websites. You probably found it suspicious and didn't click the link. Smart move. The malware would have installed itself on your computer and stolen private information. Cyber-criminals use social engineering to trick you into downloading malware off the internet or make you fill in your personal information under false pretenses.

A phishing scam in an email message can be evaded by keeping certain things in mind.

- ▶ Look for spelling mistakes in the text. Cyber-criminals are not known for their grammar and spelling.
- ▶ Hover your cursor over the hyperlinked URL but don't click. Check if the address matches with the one written in the message.
- ▶ Watch out for fake threats. Did you receive a message saying "Your email account will be closed if you don't reply to this email"? They might trick you by threatening that your security has been compromised.
- ▶ Attackers use the names and logos of well-known web sites to deceive you. The graphics and the web addresses used in the email are strikingly similar to the legitimate ones, but they lead you to phony sites.

Not all phishing is done via email or web sites. Vishing (voice phishing) involves calls to victims using fake identity fooling you into considering the call to be from a trusted organisation. They may claim to be from a bank asking you to dial a number (provided by VoIP service and owned by attacker) and enter your account details. Once you do that, your account security is compromised. Treat all unsolicited phone calls with skepticism and never provide any personal information. Many banks have issued preemptive warnings informing their users of phishing scams and the do's and don'ts regarding your account information. Those of you reading Digit for long enough will remember that we successfully phished hundreds of our readers by reporting a way to hack other people's gmail accounts by sending an email to a made up account with your own username and password... and we did that years ago in a story about , yes, you guessed it, phishing!

6. Email bombing and spamming

Email bombing is characterised by an abuser sending huge volumes of email to a target address resulting in victim's email account or mail servers crashing. The message is meaningless and excessively long in order to consume network resources. If multiple accounts of a mail server are targeted, it may have a denial-of-service impact.